



Britannia Secondary Community School

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To Whom It May Concern:

This reference is in support of Stephanie Slen's application for the TD Community Leadership Scholarship. I have known Stephanie since Grade 8. I have taught Stephanie in Science 8 Venture and IB Biology 11. Stephanie demonstrates strong academic capabilities above the 90th percentile. She has attained Honour Roll and Principal's List standing for every term since Grade 8. I have witnessed Stephanie's participation in the Britannia School Science Fairs. Stephanie is a hardworking, conscientious, motivated and dedicated student. Stephanie demonstrates attributes for life-long learning and academic success. She is inquisitive, reflective, caring and open-minded. She shows critical thinking and communication skills in and out of the classroom.

Stephanie jumps to every opportunity especially in community leadership. Stephanie is the Students' Council President this year which speaks to Stephanie's leadership qualities and desire to create social changes with the Student Council platform. She is advocating to establish diverse voices such as the SOGI (Sexual Orientation and Gender Identity) Representative and the Indigenous Representative. She is keen to look at ways for Britannia to act on truth and reconciliation and to support minority groups. Stephanie was on council last year and spearheaded a humanitarian fundraiser for Ukraine. She is on the Britannia Board of Management as a Youth Representative. With this role, she is liaising between the high school, the Vancouver School Board, the city of Vancouver and the Britannia Community Centre to look at the community renewal plan for the site. Her input is important for creating safe spaces and programming for youth. Also, Stephanie can contribute her ideas of sustainability to the community development plans since Stephanie has been highly involved with environmental leadership programs such as SOYL (Sustainable Opportunities of Youth Leadership) and Youth to Sea. With SOYL by Fresh Roots, Stephanie has learnt to grow food and address food security with local community gardens. She has developed an appreciation for urban agriculture, a farm to table concept in supporting local farmers' markets, growers and businesses. She

served as a participant, mentor and a volunteer with the SOYL program. She has extended this experience to creating a school club called Beyond the Plate. As president of Beyond the Plate, Stephanie aims to maintain the Britannia school gardens and to foster sustainability initiatives through cooking and gardening. In addition, Stephanie is utilizing her skills and knowledge as the Sustainability Coordinator on the Strathcona Interact Club where she has led gardening workshops for the community. The Strathcona Interact Club services and supports the community with other projects such as Breakfast with Santa and Toy Drives. Through the Youth to Sea program, Stephanie has been able to exhibit her passion for activism and advocacy for ocean conservation. She did beach clean ups and led workshops. For her Ocean Service Project, she organized a clothing swap to promote reduce, reuse and recycle awareness of textile wastes. Stephanie is a Teen Leader with the Writer's Exchange which is an afterschool literacy program for ages 6-18. Here, Stephanie is able to continue her community outreach while advocating for education. Stephanie attended SHAD Canada, a STEAM summer program to explore the topic of "How to improve the mental health of Canadians?" While addressing a question that resonates with her at a personal level, Stephanie and her group took the design and entrepreneurial challenge by developing a bracelet called "Brace Band" under the BRACE4Help non-profit organization. The Brace Band is equipped with an overdose sensor and an emergency contact system. The hope is to help the homeless populations that may be battling with mental health and substance addictions. What is truly admirable is how Stephanie takes her experiences and is then inspired to take action. She is a co-founder of Nurtured Youth Community. Check out their Instagram @nurturedyouthcommunity. This organization aims to break the barriers of access for youth to connect to services, resources, therapy and support related to mental health and well-being. Stephanie's community engagement is very impressive to accomplish all of this as a teenager.

With her ambitions, resiliency and tenacity, she has very high academic potential to continue to excel in post-secondary in the field of Law and Social Justice. Stephanie Slen is a deserving candidate to receive the TD Scholarship for Community Leadership.

Sincerely,



Yulanda Ng

A Community School in a Multicultural Setting